

Sizzling! UK Hits 30.5°C and It's Only Going to Get Hotter!

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Wow, it's a scorcher! On Saturday, the UK baked under the hottest day of the year so far. The temperature hit 30.5°C (that's about 87°F) in Frittenden, Kent. That's hotter than the day before, which was already a toasty 28.4°C in London. And guess what? It's going to get even hotter over the long weekend! Weather experts say Monday could be the hottest May day ever recorded in the UK, with temperatures possibly reaching 33°C or even 34°C. That would smash the old record of 32.8°C set way back in 1944. Because of the heat, **amber alerts** are in place for parts of England. That means the heat could be dangerous, especially for kids and people over 65. The rest of England has yellow alerts, so everyone should be careful. The good news? After some cloudy days, Scotland and Northern Ireland will get sunny and warm too, with Glasgow maybe hitting the mid-20s. But if you're heading to the east coast of England, watch out for **mist**! This early **heatwave** is a sign of our changing **climate**. So, whether you're at a medieval **jousting** show or just chilling in a park, stay cool, drink lots of water, and slap on that sunscreen!

Word Treasure

amber alert -- A warning that hot weather could be dangerous, especially for kids and older people.

heatwave -- A long period of very hot weather, hotter than normal for that place.

jousting -- A sport from medieval times where knights on horseback try to knock each other off with lances.

mist -- A thin fog, especially near the coast, that can make it hard to see.

temperature record -- The highest temperature ever measured for a certain time and place.

climate -- The usual weather of a place over many years, which is changing across the world.

Background you need

The UK usually has mild summers, so a temperature of 30°C is rare and can strain hospitals and power supplies. In 1944, during World War II, the previous May record of 32.8°C was set.

Today, scientists say climate change is making extreme heat events like this more likely. The Met Office, the UK's national weather service, issues amber and yellow alerts to warn people of danger.

Frittenden is a small village in Kent, in southeastern England, where the first day's high temperature was recorded.

Break it down

WHO: People across the UK, with kids and the elderly especially warned to be careful

WHAT: Temperatures hit 30.5°C, the hottest day of the year so far, with health alerts and record-breaking heat on the way

WHERE: Highest in Frittenden, Kent (England), with Scotland and Northern Ireland also turning sunny and warm

WHY: A weather pattern brought hot air, but scientists link early intense heat to our changing climate

Why it matters

When the weather gets extremely hot, it can be dangerous for kids playing outside and for older relatives, so knowing how to stay safe--like drinking water and using sunscreen--helps us all enjoy summer without getting sick.

Test what you remember

1. Where was the highest temperature of the day recorded?
 - (A) Frittenden, Kent
 - (B) London
 - (C) Glasgow
 - (D) Edinburgh
2. What temperature could Monday possibly reach?
 - (A) 30°C or 31°C
 - (B) 33°C or 34°C
 - (C) 28°C or 29°C
 - (D) 35°C or 36°C
3. What was the old May temperature record for the UK?
 - (A) 31.8°C set in 1954
 - (B) 32.8°C set in 1944
 - (C) 30.2°C set in 1936
 - (D) 33.5°C set in 1928
4. What kind of health alerts are in place because of the heat?
 - (A) red and orange
 - (B) amber and yellow
 - (C) green and blue
 - (D) purple and white
5. Where might people see misty conditions?
 - (A) on the east coast of England
 - (B) in Scotland
 - (C) in Northern Ireland
 - (D) in central London
6. What is this early heatwave a sign of?
 - (A) a normal summer
 - (B) changing climate
 - (C) a new weather pattern in Kent
 - (D) better weather reporting

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: B 4: B 5: A 6: B

1. **Weather forecasters:** They see this as a serious event that could break May records, urging people to take precautions.
2. **Health officials:** They worry about heatstroke and extra strain on hospitals, especially for the elderly and children.
3. **Climate scientists:** They note that such early and intense heat fits a pattern of global warming, signaling more record heat in the future.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):